

## Passport FAQ — Nepal

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### Category 1: Application

**Q: Where do I apply for a passport?** A: For urgent/fast-track service, apply at the Department of Passports, Tripureshwor, Kathmandu. For regular service, apply at your District/Area Administration Office (DAO/AAO). If abroad, apply at the nearest Nepali mission.

**Q: How long does it take to get a passport?** A: Department of Passports: 2 working days. DAO/AAO: 15–45 days. Nepali missions abroad: 15 days to 2 months.

**Q: Can someone else apply on my behalf?** A: No. You must be present in person for biometric enrollment. For collection only, an authorized relative with a written authorization (*Manjurinama*) may collect on your behalf.

**Q: Can I change my appointment date after submitting the form?** A: No, the system does not allow self-changes. Contact the enrollment office directly for assistance.

**Q: Which should I choose — 34-page or 66-page passport?** A: If you travel frequently, choose 66 pages. Both have equal international recognition.

**Q: Is there a higher chance of getting a visa with a 66-page passport?** A: No. Both passport sizes have the same recognition worldwide.

**Q: How do I pay the passport fee?** A: In Nepal: pay at a specified bank, online, or via digital payment. Abroad: as specified by the respective mission.

**Q: How long does passport collection take?** A: About 10–15 minutes.

**Q: When is it time to renew my passport?** A: When less than 1 year of validity remains, or earlier if lost, damaged, pages full, surname changed, minor turns 16, or appearance has significantly changed.

**Q: Can I still use my valid Machine Readable Passport (MRP)?** A: Yes. No need to switch to an e-passport until it expires or meets renewal conditions.

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### Category 2: Documents

**Q: Do I need to bring a photo for the e-passport?** A: No. A live photo is taken at the enrollment center. Exception: children under 5 who cannot sit still must bring a photo.

**Q: Is the National Identity Card (NID) mandatory?** A: Yes, for applicants aged 16 and above applying in Nepal. Not required for minors under 16 or applicants at Nepali missions abroad.

**Q: My passport is lost and I don't have a copy. Can I still apply?** A: Yes. Contact the relevant enrollment center or the Department of Passports to retrieve your previous application details.

**Q: What passport details should I retrieve if lost — is a copy required?** A: No copy is required. The Department can look up previous records. Visit the nearest enrollment center.

**Q: Can jewelry or makeup be worn in the passport photo?** A: Small, regularly worn jewelry (e.g., a small nose stud) is acceptable if it doesn't cover facial features. Party jewelry must be removed. Light, natural makeup is fine. Tika is best avoided.

**Q: What if I have a permanent facial tattoo or scar?** A: No action needed for permanent marks. For temporary scars, wait for healing if possible. If urgent, the passport can be issued now and renewed later.

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### **Category 3: Errors & Issues**

**Q: I found an error in my online form after submitting. What do I do?** A: Request a correction from the verification staff at the enrollment center before your photo is taken. Once the photo is taken and form is signed, no corrections are possible.

**Q: There is an error in my issued passport. What do I do?** A: You must apply for a new passport. If the error was the office's fault → free of charge. If the error was your fault → full applicable fee applies.

**Q: Can the emergency contact name in my passport be changed?** A: Only by applying for a new passport — the full process applies.

**Q: I received my passport but it has errors. How do I fix it?** A: Apply for a new passport following the same renewal process. The passport itself cannot be corrected after printing.

**Q: What if the appointment slot is not visible for an Area Office or embassy?** A: Contact the concerned office or mission directly — they control appointment availability.

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### **Category 4: Lost, Stolen & Damaged Passport**

**Q: What do I do if my passport is lost?** A: Visit the nearest enrollment center with valid identification. Report the loss to officially cancel the passport and prevent misuse, then apply for a replacement.

**Q: Do I need a police report or newspaper notice for a lost passport?** A: No. The Department of Passports directly notifies Interpol to cancel the lost passport.

**Q: What if I find my lost passport after a new one is issued?** A: Immediately contact the enrollment center to cancel it. The old passport cannot be used — attempting to travel with it may result in legal action.

**Q: What if my passport is damaged or unusable?** A: Apply for a replacement. Additional fees apply (see fee table in passport\_basics).

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## **Category 5: Renewal & Passport Number**

**Q: Does renewing a passport keep the same passport number?** A: No. A new number is assigned. The new passport references the old number, so both can be carried if a visa is in the old passport. Check the destination country's visa rules.

**Q: I have a visa in my old passport — is it still valid after renewal?** A: Generally yes, since the new passport references the old number. However, rules vary by country — verify with the destination country's authorities.

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## **Category 6: Special Cases**

**Q: Can a relative in Nepal apply for my passport while I am abroad?** A: No. You must be present in person, or apply at the nearest Nepali mission in your country.

**Q: What if I applied at an embassy but need to return to Nepal before receiving my passport?**

A: Inform the embassy. They can arrange for the Department of Passports in Nepal to issue the passport. Collect it there with the embassy's recommendation letter and required documents.

**Q: My child was born abroad — how do I get them a passport?** A: Contact the nearest Nepali mission. Bring both parents' citizenship and passport copies, marriage certificate, child's birth certificate, and 2 passport photos. The mission will issue a birth/temporary registration number for the application.

**Q: After my child's passport is issued abroad, is a Minor Identity Card required?** A: Yes. After the passport is issued, you must obtain a Minor Identity Card from the relevant DAO/AAO in Nepal — required for all future renewals.

**Q: What is a temporary passport?** A: A handwritten passport issued by a Nepali mission abroad for urgent situations. It is mainly used to return to Nepal and in some countries to apply for a visa. Verify usability with your country of residence before applying.

**Q: I live in a different district from where my citizenship was issued. Can I apply locally?** A: Yes, if you have a Migration Certificate. You can also always apply at the Department of Passports in Kathmandu regardless of district.